

Explaining the LifeRamp Superpower Quiz

Understand your natural impact



Superpower Quiz Tool

By: LifeRamp

Third Edition

© LifeRamp November 2024

<https://liferamp360.com/superpower-quiz/>



Contents

Chapter 1...Introduction	2
Chapter 2...What is a superpower?	3
Chapter 3...Overview of the Superpowers:	6
Chapter 4...Over-doing the super powers: Too much of a good thing?	17
Chapter 5...What is my Superpower?	20
Chapter 6...Identifying superpowers in others:	22
Chapter 7...What's important about knowing your superpower?	24
Chapter 8...Using your superpower when Coaching	26
Chapter 9...For Educators	29
Chapter 10...Superpowers and Teams	33
Chapter 11...What is your kryptonite?	38
Conclusion	39
Appendix 1...Self Assessment Sample	40
Appendix 2...360 Peer Assessment	44

Methodology

By:

Sue Abuelsamid, PCC

Contributors: Dan Buchner PCC, Jen Lara PCC



Chapter 1 - Introduction

Why create the Superpower Quiz?

At LifeRamp, we believe everyone has a superpower. We wanted to create an engaging quiz that felt fun and light, that helps people become more self-aware, and more able to create the impact they really want to create.

Yes, there are many self-discovery tools out there in the world, and you get to decide if this one is right for you. We took what has been learned from many other tools and assessments, and the development from coach Sue Abuelsamid along with contributions from Jen Lara and Dan Buchner, and came up with this quiz.

What's in it for you?

Something new, fun, and accessible. Something for all ages and backgrounds. A new perspective on what makes you unique and appealing to others. A new perspective on your friends, family, and colleagues when you discover what is compelling about them. A relatively easy tool to use with your students, clients, and anyone else who is curious. Something to feel good about, not to be fixed.



Chapter 2 - What is a Superpower?

For the purposes of this book and associated quiz, a superpower is something innate in us that others find compelling. It's not just a strength, it's more than that, because the power of it comes from how others are impacted by our superpower. Let's say we consider a strength to be something we are good at; that doesn't automatically make it compelling to others. It's the way we do something or show up in a way so naturally (no "trying") that people admire and are drawn to.

For example, a lot of people can be counted on to tell the truth. But someone with a superpower of **The Truthteller** has a rare gift of being able to do it in a way that even when no one wants to hear it, is received and accepted. And all of us can give a compliment, but someone with the superpower of **The Appreciator** does it with a different energy.

Our superpowers are things that are effortless for us. They are instinctive and when we are really connected to our instincts and intuition our superpowers shine, often without us even knowing. And because we are so unaware of it a lot of the time, we also don't recognize how powerful we are when we show up from the energy of our superpower. As humans we tend to work hard to improve our “weaknesses” rather than focus on our strengths, but often that is not the most effective strategy.

“In our extensive research, Gallup¹ has found that building employees' strengths is a far more effective approach to improving performance than trying to improve weaknesses. When employees know and use their strengths, they are more engaged, perform better, and are less likely to leave their company.”²

Often, when presented with a list of superpowers or attributes to choose from, people will often select the one they want to be or think they should be. Which is likely to be based on a societal expectation or seeing someone else that is “successful” do that thing very well.

It is not unusual, and in fact it is common for your self-assessment of your superpower to be different from your peer assessment, or “360”. A 360 is a survey that is completed by other people in your life, but they are answering the questions with you as the subject. So, the term “360” represents the bigger picture, a different perspective that comes into play when we ask others to share what they see in us. We are including this 360-peer assessment because we are often unaware of what makes us compelling to others, and this gives us a more accurate picture.

So, be open to the idea that you can be really good at something and love doing it, but that thing might not be your superpower. Get curious about your impact on others, and

¹ Gallup is an organization that combines analytics and advice to help leaders and organizations identify opportunities and create meaningful change.

² <https://news.gallup.com/businessjournal/167462/employees-strengths-companystronger.aspx>

how you are seen and experienced. And take from this what is useful and leave what isn't.

One final word, you will not have the same impact on all people, but it is likely that most people will be compelled by the same thing, and that is what, for our purposes here, will be your superpower. If you disagree, that's OK too. This is not meant to give you a label or an identity, just to give you a tool and increased awareness of your impact on others. It's like being let in on a little secret!



Every one of us has superpowers. We tend to have one that is more dominant and comes so naturally and we might not even know we have it.

When we become aware of our main superpower and understand it, we open the door to the opportunity to create a compelling and powerful impact on others. When we are connected with our superpowers, we are naturally more instinctive and authentic and have better capacity to build relationships and create intentional impact.

You may be surprised by what your dominant superpower is. That's because it's so natural you don't realize you have it. Also, we tend to try to be things we are not in order to be seen in a "better" way. For example, a person might imagine that it is more important to be perceived as an initiator and might therefore hide their actual superpower because sometimes speaking the truth makes others uncomfortable. The irony is that we are more authentic and appealing to others when we connect with and utilize our true superpowers.

Young kids are more likely to freely express their superpowers but as we get older we learn to "fit in" and often suppress the parts of ourselves that make us who we really are. When we begin to show up and lead with our superpower, everything is easier.

And remember, we have more than one superpower, in fact all of us have a bit of all the superpowers in us, and we can nurture and develop those other superpowers so that they are available to us when we need them. However, one tends to be more prominent

and therefore shows up more naturally and authentically (when we don't hide it). Good leaders use their superpowers to be compelling, and know when to draw on other superpowers and/or create teams of people with a variety of superpowers in certain situations to create a particular impact.

Another thing to keep in mind is that these superpowers remain dynamic, meaning we are not all going to embody every possible aspect of our superpower, it will not look exactly the same on every person who embodies that same superpower. We are still all unique humans. There is nothing you're supposed to do, and this is not meant to be a label to define you or put you in a box or category of any kind.

Identifying your superpower is meant to give you a new perspective, or perhaps new insight into your authentic self and your impact on others. There is no right or wrong, there is no better or worse superpower, they all have value.

Key Takeaways:

- A superpower is something innate in us that others find compelling
- When we are really connected to our instincts and intuition our superpower shines often without us even knowing
- Superpowers are dynamic, meaning we are not all going to embody every possible aspect of our superpower all the time

Chapter 3 - Overview of the Superpowers:

There are 7 Superpowers:

The Visionary,

The Space Shifter,

The Truth Teller,

The Engager,

The Initiator,

The Appreciator,

and The Rebel.



The Engager

When this is your superpower others feel more at ease and relaxed around you. You have an inviting energy that draws people to you. You can be perceived as playful, lighthearted and/or fun. You are genuine, present, and warm. You listen to others with compassionate curiosity. For example, at a coffee shop or at a gathering, you attract others to you and engage easily in conversation. In the workplace, colleagues are more inclined to share a workspace with you or be more inclined to be on a team with you. Because of your ability to put others at ease, you are able to work and interact effectively with a broad range of people - even the most difficult ones. You tend to look upon strangers as friends you have not met yet and are interested in connecting rather than controlling.

Your mantra might be... “connecting with people is my jam”.

One of the things that you least like to hear/experience is exclusivity.



The Visionary

When this is your superpower, you are an out-of-the-box thinker who sees possibilities in everything. You have the power of imagination, are resourceful and intuitive, and see opportunities to solve problems in new and often surprising ways. You have the capacity to see what is right in front of you as well as how it connects to the much bigger picture. You care passionately about what is meaningful in life and want to make a difference in the world. You dare to have big dreams and believe that they are possible. Your impact on others is to make them feel anything is possible, no matter how wild or unorthodox the idea may initially seem. You often energize others with your belief and compel them to action with that energy. At your best not only can you imagine the impossible becoming real, but you can also find the people or team to get it there. To be most effective you must be aware of how far others are willing to stretch, or risk leaving them behind. Because of your seemingly limitless creativity and energy, you also may create the unintended impact of having everyone come to you to solve their problems.

Your mantra might be..." of course we can" or "we can figure this out".

One of the things that you least like to hear/experience is "that can't be done".



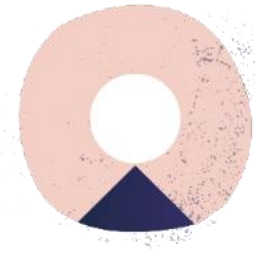
The Space Shifter

When this is your superpower, you can change the energy of a room without saying a word. You are exquisitely sensitive and respectful of energy and emotion and have confidence in your intuition. You are aware when there is something beneath the surface and are able to transform the energy of the space when needed and you often know just when that energy shift is needed. People tend to acknowledge and appreciate when you shift the energy, and it often serves to illuminate different perspectives, and bring people together. People may let you get away with things that others might not, and you have a significant impact. Your space shifting takes others by surprise but that impact is balanced by your ability to connect without words and create a safe, comfortable space. You may often be referred to as a comedian, since humor and quick wit are common among space shifters.

Your mantra might be... “never miss the opportunity to point out what's important when others don't see it”.

One of the things that you least like to hear/experience is “everyone saying the same old thing” or “that's how we'll do it because that's how we've always done it”.





The Truth Teller

When this is your superpower, you have the capacity to say what is not being said. You are transparently truthful and share that truth without pretense. You speak the truth with a peaceful confidence and have a deep respect for what is true. You tend to ask for what you need by making requests clearly and simply. You are discerning about timing, too. A truth teller in their full power is aware of the readiness of the recipient to hear the truth. People are both drawn to you and somewhat afraid and intimidated by you because they sense you will tell them the truth. People tend to trust you, and trust that if something needs to be said you will say it. A truth teller doesn't experience discomfort when it comes to telling hard truths and is able to do so with compassion and empathy. Others may view you as the voice of the unseen and unheard.

Your mantra might be... truth is power.

One of the things that you least like to hear/experience is “beating around the bush”.





The Initiator

When this is your superpower, you are forward moving and you get things going. You are decisive, are able to choose a path and hold an action plan, though can also be flexible and open to new possibilities. You tackle life's challenges with courage and determination. You are reliable and you do what needs to be done even in the face of obstacles. When a crisis happens people often look to you to take the first step forward. Because you make it look easy, you may find that others come to you with ideas that they can't get started, looking for guidance or leadership to get things going. People are often inspired by how much you get done. People expect a lot of you, and you expect a lot of yourself.

Your mantra might be...“put ideas into action”

One of the things that you least like to hear/experience is inefficiency, or bureaucracy and regulations that prevent things from getting started or finished.





The Appreciator

When this is your superpower, you notice and name the value in people and ideas. You tend to have a positive outlook and trust that things will work out. You thrive on demonstrating gratitude and appreciation. You have energy of grace and the ability to step back and recognize the gifts in any person or situation and turn difficult situations into opportunities for growth. You are open and curious and do not tend to stand in judgment of others but instead see the treasures that lie within.

You believe in and see potential in others even more than others may believe in themselves. You make people feel appreciated and celebrate people for who they are. This can also have the impact of motivating others and boosting their confidence. In your presence, people open up and share who they are as they feel inherently valuable.

Your mantra might be..."gratitude solves everything"

One of the things that you least like to hear/experience is "that's a bad idea"





The Rebel

When this is your superpower, you challenge the status quo. You dare to be true to yourself and you show up with passion. You have the capacity to endure, and you embrace life without holding back even in the face of challenge or difficulties. You are a risk taker, often with purpose and to support the greater good. You do not necessarily enjoy risks for the sake of taking them; risk taking generally comes naturally only when it honors your core values and stake. You tend to choose the road less travelled and have the confidence to take bold steps and break boundaries. You can be the voice of the voiceless - defending people that have been persecuted or mistreated. Non-attached to social norms, you have the confidence to abandon projects or initiatives when they are no longer serving.

Your mantra might be “forge your own path”.

One of the things that you least like to hear/experience is “this is how you should do it” or “this is how it’s always done”.



Superpower Characteristics



- Warm
- Present
- Genuine
- Connector
- Compassionate
- Curious
- Storyteller
- Charming
- Responsive
- Inviting



- Imaginative
- Flexible
- Original
- Playful
- Passionate
- Curious
- Courageous
- Determined
- Enterprising
- Idealist



- Sensitive
- Confident
- Aware
- Witty
- Insightful
- Perceptive
- Sharp-thinker
- Respectful
- Tuned-in
- Independent



- Honest
- Direct
- Confident
- Respectful
- Insightful
- Courageous
- Compassionate
- Candid
- Credible
- Concise



- Resourceful
- Capable
- Reliable
- Determined
- Decisive
- Organized

- Efficient
- Imaginative
- Steady
- Implementer



The Appreciator

- Mindful
- Curious
- Positive
- Grateful
- Reflective
- Observant
- Thoughtful
- Present
- Accepting
- Cheerleader



The Rebel

- Enthusiastic
- Certain
- Confident
- Daring
- Creative
- Fearless
- Risk-taker
- Courageous
- Passionate
- Audacious



Chapter 4 - Overdoing the superpowers: Too much of a good thing?

The interesting thing about superpowers is we don't have to try to do them, they show up almost effortlessly when we are our authentic selves. Occasionally we may forget that and force the issue. When that happens, we can create unintended impact and things can go awry. As well, sometimes we lean into a superpower that isn't really ours and can have unintentional impact and actually cause people to retreat or disengage or rebel.

Here are some examples of what can happen when we “overplay” or “try too hard” or try to lean hard into a different superpower. The latter can tend to happen when we think we should show up or “be different” than we actually are.



Engager: When you are over-doing Engager, you may have a tendency to withdraw from people if the connections are not meaningful. You may have difficulty establishing clear boundaries which can lead to exhaustion and disengagement. People may take advantage of your welcoming nature and overshare or dump on you. If/when you try too hard to be an engager, you might have a tendency to barrel over people, take over conversations, or intimidate them. They may result in people not feeling valued or in viewing you as insincere.



The Visionary: When you are over-doing creative/visionary you may find yourself lost in a sea of ideas and going nowhere. You may find yourself at risk of going down many rabbit holes, burning resources, especially people, and causing them to lose faith. Because of your almost indefatigable faith others may see you as simply a dreamer, reaching too far, impractical, and

with unrealistic goals. This may have the unintended effect of keeping them at arm's length, causing them to never give the idea a chance, and potentially leaving you feeling frustrated.



Space Shifter: When you over play this superpower you also have a big impact, though probably unintended impact. People may think you are trying to draw attention to yourself, and you might push people away, get resistance, or notice disengagement and hurt feelings. Because it is not unusual for humor or wit to be your vehicle for shifting space you may not always be taken seriously.



Truth Teller: When you overdo this superpower you can definitely be intimidating and scary. In extreme cases you might be perceived as a bully. The impact may be that people don't come to you for advice or help. Timing is also critical, and not being respectful of when and how you deliver the truth may create resentment and disengagement.



Initiator: When you overdo this superpower you may suffer from burn out or exhaustion. If you don't establish good boundaries, you could end up taking on too much for others. Sometimes you may feel like you go it alone, and you may not be great at asking for help. When you aren't discerning you may say yes to a lot of things that you don't want to do or are not in alignment with your core values. And when you say yes to everything, it may have the impact of making others feel like you're "taking over," or you are "too much". That can lead to withdrawal and disengagement due to people not feeling seen or valued, or even paralysis.



Appreciator: When you over-play this superpower, it may come off as insincere. It may also influence others to do less because they know you are easily pleased. You may be seen as just a people pleaser or “yes” person. When overdone, Appreciators can be taken advantage of as they can be engulfed in new ideas or initiatives without being discerning enough. You may feel like you give, give, give, and not get back because you assume others know how to appreciate, too.



Rebel: When overdone, Rebels can be perceived as rule breakers, black sheep or people who do not respect authority or social norms. Others may want to keep their distance from you or disassociate from you. Ironically, others may view you as having no purpose or direction. You may also be seen as disruptive. You tend to react poorly when people tell you how to think and behave and there can be almost a visceral and instinctive push back. Non-attached to social norms around follow through and completion, you may abandon projects or initiatives prematurely or you may be perceived as not caring, lacking follow through, or unreliable.

Key Takeaways:

- We don't have to try to do our superpowers, they show up almost effortlessly when we are our authentic selves

- Sometimes we lean into a superpower that isn't really ours, and can have unintentional impact and actually cause people to retreat or disengage or rebel
- When we “overdo” our superpower it can cast a shadow over the gifts that it brings, which can create a lot of unintended impact that may have the opposite effect of what you are striving for

Chapter 5 - What is my Superpower?

At this point you are probably wondering, “How do I determine my superpower?” That's a great question. How accurately we can identify our own superpower really depends on how self-aware we are. Since superpowers are all about our impact on others, it can be very difficult to know unless people give us very clear and specific feedback, and often.



It is said that the only constant in life is change. And that applies to superpowers as well. It is possible that our dominant superpower will change and evolve over time. We are the product of our experiences, and it is possible that different superpowers may be more compelling in different contexts. However overall, it's likely that the majority of the time one or two superpowers will stand out and be most compelling to those around us. So back to the question, “How do I identify my superpower?”

First and foremost, think about the way that people react to you. Think about what they tell you they admire in you, or the quality you have that they wish they had. Notice when you seem to be most “attractive” to people, in the sense of them approaching you with curiosity, hovering nearby, asking questions, watching you with curiosity or admiration. Those are indicators that your superpower is showing up strongly and effectively.

When reading through the descriptions of the superpowers, think about which words you have frequently heard used to describe you in a positive way. Think about the times you've been at your absolute best in a situation. What was it that made it so?

The first step is to self-assess. As previously mentioned, often our self-assessment will not give us an accurate indication of our true superpower(s), because we don't necessarily see ourselves the way others see us. Also, we are not always aware of the real impact we are having on others.

Another factor is that we tend to answer the questions in the quiz based on a conscious or unconscious bias of what we think we “should” be like. Those biases come from our parents, teachers, past experiences, media, etc. and often have less to do with who we are as a person and more to do with how we have learned to interpret human behavior. All of that, of course, may not be related to how our peers, friends, and co-workers see us, or what they want and need from us. The same behaviors can mean different things to different people. Without an understanding of how/why someone else views the world it is very difficult to accurately assess our impact on them.

Also, we humans often hide our true feelings about others for fear of offending someone or “rocking the boat,” or perhaps out of a fear of displaying vulnerability. So, you may not be able to tell for sure how you impact others based solely on what you see or what they tell you.

Finally, our superpowers tend to be so natural to us that we don’t even realize we are doing or being that thing. That’s what makes it so special, and so great. And also, sometimes makes it tricky to identify or be aware of. How can we identify a behavior that comes so naturally that we do it without thinking of it as a superpower? It kind of seems like a superpower should be something we have to work hard at...Wrong!!

So, you can see why self-assessments can be tricky, which begs the question, “Why bother with the self-assessment?”

Great question. Mostly to gauge how self aware we are, and to be able to compare our perception of ourselves with how others see and experience us.

Taking the quiz:

When taking this quiz choose the answer that feels most natural, usually that will be your first instinct. Don't overthink it.

Like any self-assessment tool, the result is an indication of how we see ourselves, or how we “think” we are showing up in the world. There’s nothing inherently wrong with that, except that as mentioned earlier unless we are getting very specific and frequent feedback, most of us have little clue how we actually impact others.

As difficult as it may feel, choose only the most resonant answer for each question. Don’t overthink it.

And finally, please don't think of this as a "test" that you are getting "scored" on. It's not like that, and one superpower is not "better" than any other. As we will see later, we need all of them in our lives to really create productive and sustainable teams and be able to fully support each other as humans.

Key Takeaways:

- It is important to remember that self-assessments are really a reflection of how we see ourselves, what we remember of our experiences, and the feedback that we have been given
- Your superpower is a reflection of what others say that they are drawn to; what they admire, and really cherish about you
- Our superpowers tend to be so natural to us that we don't even realize we are doing or being that thing

Chapter 6 - Identifying superpowers in others:

First of all, why would we want to know someone else's superpower? Or complete a 360 assessment? Well, for one thing, when we know our superpower, we have a chance to create greater intentional impact with less effort, because we don't have to "try" so hard to show up that way. Knowing someone's superpower can also give us a new perspective or insight into a person and something new to appreciate. At the very least, it helps us understand better why we "show up" the way we do.



In the following chapters we will explore how our superpowers can help us be better leaders, coaches, and educators, but for now we will focus on how to identify the superpower of someone we know.

As mentioned earlier, since we are often unaware of our own superpowers, without the 360 feedback it would be rather difficult to gain an accurate sense of what our superpower really is. And as mentioned earlier in the Gallup studies, when we lean into what we are good at, we achieve much better results than when we try to improve what we are not naturally good at.

So, that leaves us with the question - how can we identify someone's superpower? When determining someone's superpower, start by considering what you find most compelling about them. For instance, they may be good (or even excellent) at something, or exhibit a behavior often, but that might not be what makes you drawn to them, or admire them. Consider your experience of interacting with or even observing that person. How does it leave you feeling when they acknowledge a great idea compared with when they take the lead on a project or share a new idea or crack a joke to break the tension in a room? That is a reflection of their impact.

So, it is not based on what you see the person do a lot of, or even what they seem to do well. It reflects what YOU find most compelling about them. For example, consider the question of whether a person is more forthcoming or more daring. They may more often be daring, but what you find compelling is when they are forthcoming. In that case you would choose forthcoming when completing their 360 version of the quiz.

Our superpower is something that we do naturally, without effort, and which is often appreciated, admired, or respected by others. Someone's superpower may even make you uncomfortable, but you still find it compelling when they show up that way.

When completing the 360 quiz, or even just contemplating what someone's superpower is, consider all of that. Select the behavior that you see them do most instinctively or naturally, or that you find most compelling. Remember, we will not impact every single person that we interact with in the same way. The results will often show that we have a bit of every superpower in us, however most often one will stand out.

Quite often our self-assessment will differ from the results of the 360. Why is that? Does that mean we don't know ourselves? Or that we are deluded? Of course, it doesn't, what it means is that we see ourselves through a different lens than others see us. If our 360 reveals that most people are most compelled by our superpower of The Appreciator, that doesn't mean that we are not also part visionary or rebel or initiator, or any/all of the superpowers. It simply means that we are most compelling to the majority of people when we lean into our natural appreciator. And here's the thing, we need all of the superpowers in our world. We can't all be all things to all people, and most importantly we don't entirely get to choose what impact we have on others. We can certainly be intentional and mindful, however how we are perceived is ultimately not completely within our control.



Key Takeaways:

- Knowing someone's superpower can also give us a new perspective or insight into a person and something new to appreciate
- When determining someone's superpower, start by considering what you find most compelling about them
- Our superpower is something that we do naturally, without effort, and which is often appreciated, admired, or respected by others



Chapter 7 - What's important about knowing your superpower?

In the end life is all about people and relationships, so we are going to talk generally here about how knowing and understanding our superpowers can be useful to all of us. Later in Chapters 8, 9 and 10, we will explore how superpowers specifically impact coaches, coaching, teams, leadership, and education.

We humans spend a good deal of time trying to “improve” ourselves, to meet a standard that has been created by society, advertising, parents, employers, etc. But as we saw earlier, studies show again and again that focusing on our weaknesses is not the best use of our time, so now we can stop trying to “fix” ourselves. The wonderful thing about a superpower is it's fairly effortless.



Once we know our superpower and we can appreciate it, along with the superpowers of others, we can learn to love ourselves more. We can also let go of trying to be all things to all people and stop trying to fit into boxes that are the wrong size or shape for us. We can focus on what we are good at. And we can grow exponentially faster as humans and leaders.

Gallup, the organization that developed the Strengths finder assessment tool³ places a focus on what we do best. Superpowers are simply another approach that integrates the perspective of other people in our lives. Neither is necessarily better, they just give us different language and options to work with. You get to choose what is most resonant for you in any context.

“Ultimately the data show that managers who focus on the strengths of their employees create the strongest levels of engagement: These managers can achieve a 60:1 ratio of engaged to actively disengaged employees. Managers can reach that ratio when they realize that employees want to matter. And focusing on people's strengths is a crucial way to show them that they matter. Employees with managers who focus on their strengths begin to understand that they are unique and that they can contribute based on the talents that make them unique. They also understand that they are not just a cog in the wheel, but an important part of something greater than themselves. "A strengths-focused environment helps me think about becoming the best I can be based on the unique talents that I bring to my workplace," Larry said. "And that is a pretty engaging feeling." This feeling also generates superior performance. Teams with higher engagement levels have significantly higher productivity and profitability than workgroups with lower engagement levels.”

The Superpower approach, focusing and building on what we do best, and what people are most compelled by allows us to do great work, and be even more engaging, drawing people in, in way that can foster trusting relationships.



Key Takeaways:

³ <https://news.gallup.com/businessjournal/124214/driving-engagement-focusingstrengths.aspx>

- Gallup has found that building employees' strengths is a far more effective approach to improving performance than trying to improve weaknesses
- Knowing your superpower can bring a sense of ease into our lives, as long as we let go of trying to be something we are not.
- When we understand and lean into our superpowers, we will attract people to us who appreciate us for who we really are

Chapter 8 - Using your superpower when Coaching

For coaches:

So how can superpowers be useful when coaching?

As a coach, knowing your superpower (i.e. knowing what is most compelling about you) can serve you in many ways.

For one thing, it might help us understand who your “ideal” clients are, or rather, who we are the “ideal coach” for, because as much as we can choose our clients, they also have to choose us. In coach training we often talk about how selecting a coach has a lot to do with “chemistry”; similar to how we decide whether or not to go on a second date with someone. And when we think about what factors into that, it is about being compelling. We are often drawn to people when it doesn’t necessarily seem to “make sense”.

Our superpowers draw people to us, often because the thing we do is exactly what they feel they need or want more of in their life. So as a coach, knowing what most people are compelled by can help us direct where we look for clients, and how we market ourselves. That’s not to say we need to exclude others, but it can certainly pay to shine a light on the thing that comes easiest to us.

How might you change your marketing based on knowing your superpower? Make a list of the resonant words from your superpower description and think about how you might use or incorporate that into your branding.

Superpowers are also incredibly useful when actually coaching. Let’s start by considering how you typically show up as a coach. Understanding that as a coach⁴ you are going to

⁴ I am using the word “coach” in accordance with the [International Coach Federation](#) guidelines and code of ethics

focus on the client's agenda, and generally matching the energy of your client ask yourself if you have a "routine" or particular demeanor that you largely maintain throughout the coaching. Now check in and notice how your dominant superpower is reflected (or not) in the way you usually coach.

Consider coaching more intentionally from the energy of your superpower - what might be different? Our superpower is intuitive, and we serve our clients best when we are really connected and dialed into our intuition. Think about the intuitive feelings you may have ignored as a coach, are they related to your superpower?

For your coaching clients:

What keeps you from using your superpower as a coach?

There are many ways in which the concept of superpowers can add richness to your coaching and the experience that your clients get to have. As mentioned above, your superpower, when fully empowered, is a gift to your clients, often offering them a taste of exactly what they need or want to create more of in their life.

And using the assessments to uncover your clients's superpower can lead in many wonderful and surprising directions. One way to use the tool of superpowers is simply to explore all of them and see what comes up for the client. What are they attracted to? What do they see in themselves? How does the idea of having a superpower serve them? What changes when they stand in the perspective of their authentic selves embodying a superpower?

Getting connected with our superpower can help us to overcome negative stories, saboteurs, and challenges. It can act as a form of sage because it comes from within and knows just when to show up (when we allow it space to be present). Sometimes it is a saboteur that gets in the way of



leaning into our superpowers. Even that visual can be helpful – every superhero has an arch enemy, right? What do those superheroes do, or how do they have to be in order to overcome those enemies (aka saboteurs)?

When your clients begin to understand their superpower they have an opportunity to become more self-aware, to recognize their impact and to be more intentional in the way they show up in various situations. The bigger impact is that they can make better decisions, improve the nature of their interactions with others, and move toward their goals. Our clients can more clearly see and accept who they are and be more cognizant of how they want to spend their time and who they want to work with. Understanding the positive aspects of our superpower is huge because as mentioned earlier many of us have been told previously that it was “bad behavior” or unappreciated.

When we asked an experienced coach what the impact of knowing her superpower was on her coaching she said, “The qualities of the superpower are often the opposite of where you have difficulties”. For example, she said, “I am a truth teller so when I think I am too opinionated I remember that often the things that are challenging about me are also the greatest gifts that I can offer the world.”⁵

As a coach, she has the gift of naming hard truths, and being direct and respectful. Sometimes our clients really need this, and not everyone has this gift. Leaning into our superpower can give our clients more of what they really are looking for and bring a whole new dimension of you as a coach.



Another coach we spoke with said this about knowing and leaning into her superpower: “As a coach, it has helped trust my intuition more. I think it’s also strengthened my presence. For my clients, it’s another gateway to awareness and helps them better leverage their strengths.”⁶

A Space Shifter coach shared this; “Knowing [your] superpower is claiming strength. With healthy clean air, I know this sensitivity and insight is something I bring. With it I speak truth and name things that others may sense or have no awareness of them. As a coach this ability to name things that are present for my clients is a powerful tool. It’s a way of holding up a mirror that can reflect things much deeper than the surface.”

Key Takeaways:

⁵ PCC ICF certified coach

⁶ PCC ICF certified coach

- Knowing your superpower can help you identify your ideal clients and target your marketing
- When a client knows and understands their superpower, they can leverage it to help them move toward their goals
- Working with superpowers can expand your range as a coach and enable you to better serve your clients



Chapter 9 - For Educators

There are many reasons to get students connected with their superpowers.

As educators, building resilience in your students is very important. It is not enough to tell kids they can do anything; it often takes more than hard work and positive energy. Kids need to know they have skills (superpowers) and what those superpowers are. Whether they have been labelled as odd or gifted or something else, labels come with attributes and tendencies and stigmas that can help or hinder progress toward a goal.

Take for example, a very common report card comment, "Gets distracted easily". That is generally not seen as a good thing. It might mean "inability to focus" or "hyperactive" or "lacks social skills". But that is just one way of looking at it. The key is to take that tendency to become distracted and turn it into an advantage, aka a superpower. Perhaps being too focused can cause us to miss out on other things around us. Do you remember the parable about the secret of happiness in *The Alchemist* by Paulo Coelho?

A merchant sent his son to learn the Secret of Happiness from the wisest of men. The young man wandered through the desert for forty days until he reached a beautiful castle at the top of a mountain. There lived the sage that the young man was looking for.

However, instead of finding a holy man, our hero entered a room and saw a great deal of activity; merchants coming and going, people chatting in the corners, a small orchestra playing sweet melodies, and there was a table laden with the most delectable dishes of that part of the world.

The wise man talked to everybody, and the young man had to wait for two hours until it was time for his audience.

With considerable patience, the sage listened attentively to the reason for the boy's visit but told him that at that moment he did not have the time to explain to him the Secret of Happiness.

He suggested that the young man take a stroll around his palace and come back in two hours' time. "However, I want to ask you a favor," he added, handing the boy a teaspoon, in which he poured two drops of oil. "While you walk, carry this spoon and don't let the oil spill."

The young man began to climb up and down the palace staircases, always keeping his eyes fixed on the spoon. At the end of two hours he returned to the presence of the wise man.

"So," asked the sage, "Did you see the Persian tapestries hanging in my dining room? Did you see the garden that the Master of Gardeners took ten years to create? Did you notice the beautiful parchments in my library?"

Embarrassed, the young man confessed that he had seen nothing. His only concern was not to spill the drops of oil that the wise man had entrusted to him.

"So, go back and see the wonders of my world," said the wise man. "You can't trust a man if you don't know his house."

Now more at ease, the young man took the spoon and strolled again through the palace, this time paying attention to all the works of art that hung from the ceiling and walls. He saw the gardens, the mountains all around the palace, the delicacy of the flowers, the taste with which each work of art was placed in its niche.

Returning to the sage, he reported in detail all that he had seen.



"But where are the two drops of oil that I entrusted to you?" asked the sage. Looking down at the spoon, the young man realized that he had spilled the oil.

"Well, that is the only advice I have to give you," said the sage of sages. "The

Secret of Happiness lies in looking at all the wonders of the world and never forgetting the two drops of oil in the spoon.”⁷

The boy obviously thought having the ability to focus and follow instructions was a priority (because that is what he was taught). However, the ability to be distracted (aka curious) and notice what else is around you can be a great gift, if you use it intentionally and well. This doesn’t mean that being focused is bad, it simply means we are not “bad” or “less than” if it is not one of our gifts.

All our tendencies and traits can be great gifts if we are aware and learn how to use them.

A very important part of resiliency is understanding what your unique gifts are. What got you here? When you think back, what were the defining moments in your lives, the ones that set you up for achieving your goals? What is your superpower? What would be different for you as a teacher if you leaned into your superpower more, and helped them discover their superpowers? We have to forget this term “normal” and arm students with techniques to make the most out of their assets.

The idea of superpowers in itself can also help promote creativity simply by offering a new way to look at ourselves. Seeing ourselves in this perspective, that our real, compelling self is a superpower is both fun and light. It shifts the energy with which we view our traits and allows us to broaden how we think. That can be a great starting point to stimulate creative ideas, new perspectives for other things, and a whole new energy which we can embody and move forward with. What changes for you when you think of yourself as having superpowers? Imagine how it might empower a young child or a struggling student?

Believing in your superpowers can give you access to a whole new way forward that may not have been apparent or even imaginable before.

Here’s an example of an exercise you can do with your students to begin exploring the idea of superpowers.

What’s true about you:

- Write down 3 of your dreams

⁷ Excerpt from “The Alchemist” by Paulo Coelho

- Make a list of everything that is true about you (include things perceived as “bad” or “negative”)
- For each item in your list, consider and write down how it can actually be an advantage
- For each item in your list, write an example of how you have used it as an advantage in your life
- How can your superpowers be used to help you achieve the dreams you wrote down earlier?

Key Takeaways:

- Knowing their superpowers helps build resilience in students
- Everything about us can be a gift and help to move us forward
- Believing in our superpowers can give us a new perspective and promote our creativity



Chapter 10 - Superpowers and Teams

In the previous chapter we explored how understanding Superpowers can be useful in education. Now let's look at how knowing and understanding superpowers can be useful in team building and team dynamics.

First off, it's important to know what a team is. A team, whether it be a sports team or a work team, or any other kind of team, is a group of people who come together around a clear, shared, purpose. It's not random. There's often a clear structure, and the participation of everyone is key to attaining the team goals. You might be wondering why that is important here. Well, in order for a team to succeed it will take a diversity of members who may have specialized skills and bring different perspectives. Enter the Superpower!

We'll use the sports analogy here. Think about any sports team, and the sort of players that make up a successful team. In basketball for example, 5 players are on the court at the same time, and they all share some of the same skills, but they all have different "superpowers" without which the team would not be able to win. Every team needs a center, power forward, small forward, point guard, and shooting guard. Each of those positions requires very specific skills and together they have the potential to make up a great team. If one of those "superpower" skill sets is missing, it can make a world of difference, like being the #5 team instead of the #1 team. We can't all be amazing point guards, but that doesn't mean that what we are best at and do naturally isn't important. It is in fact, often vital to the success of a team even if it isn't the "glory" position.

Imagine a baseball team where everyone is a great hitter, but no one can catch. They likely won't get far in the rankings. Also, it is likely that there



might be a lot of internal competition between the hitters to stand out. That can create angst and frustration rather than camaraderie and collaboration. So, when assembling a team for any project or goal, knowing the superpowers of the individuals can be extremely helpful to future success.

The next thing to consider now that we have assembled a team is to ensure that everyone knows their superpower and those of their teammates.

When does a team work most effectively? There are many aspects to effective team dynamics however having a shared sense of purpose and mission and creating a sense of trust and psychological safety are key. A great way to do this is by designing relationships which gives everyone on the team an opportunity to share what they need in order to be their best selves, what they can be counted on for, and how they want to handle conflict, among other things (see appendix). But in order to really design well, it is important that everyone knows what superpowers they are bringing to the table, and to make sure the team has everything/everyone it needs to be successful.

Designing relationships is simply being very intentional about your needs/wants for a particular relationship. Every relationship, whether it be short or long term, is a thing unto itself, a third entity so to speak, made up of all the people involved. It is a way for everyone to consider and share their needs, desired outcomes, and wishes. It provides clarity and eliminates or at least drastically reduces the need to make assumptions.

Designed relationships are useful in any context but in this case we are exploring how it can help a team thrive and achieve its goals.



The process is fairly simple. Everyone comes together and has a chance to address some or all the following questions (or any other questions that they feel are important).

- What do you need in order to show up as your best self?
- What is your best hope for this team/project?
- What are we going to do when something goes wrong?
- What do we need to know about each other?
- What's your worst fear (about this team/project)?
- What requests do we have of each other?
- What agreements need to be made?
- What can the other person/people count on from you?
- What do you appreciate about the other person/people?

Now here are some questions specific to superpowers:

- What is your superpower and under what conditions does it really shine?
- What would you like the team to know about your superpower?
- How will your team handle things when someone's superpower is showing up "too much" or is "hiding out"?
- What do you most appreciate about other team members' superpowers?
- How will your team know when you are not stepping into your superpower and what should they do in that event?

Things to keep in mind:

- You don't necessarily have to go through all of these questions, 2 or 3 may be enough.
- These agreements are not set in stone, relationships are dynamic and things change over time and with different situations and factors coming into play. Be prepared to redesign if need be.



- Take one question at a time, and let each person have a chance to speak. Then go on to the next question.
- It is not your responsibility to ensure all of someone's needs; but it is important for each person to recognize their needs and find a way to fulfill them in order to show up as their best self.

We've explored the sports analogy, but how about a real-life team in your workplace?

In case it's not clear, the message: When we are part of a team, we don't all have to be great at everything. We each bring unique gifts and when we understand those gifts we work better together.



Bruce Tuckman developed a model in 1965 that helps us understand how teams are typically formed⁸. The Tuckman model is based on what typically happens in teams without intervention, meaning when teams are assigned to work together without conscious thought about individual gifts/superpowers, and personalities and backgrounds. In essence, it describes the gradual emergence of order out of chaos.

The model has four stages, as follows:

Forming: is the initial coming together as the group, when people tend to be overly polite as they get the measure of each other. The group learns about each other, sets some ground rules and begins to establish roles within the team.

Storming: happens when the politeness wears off as the realities of achieving the task together sink in. Conflict arises between team members and must be managed, if it is not to prevent the team achieving its task. (Note: this stage can largely be avoided/mitigated with clear and intentional designing of relationships).

Norming: is about developing rules and norms of behaviour that enhance collaboration. Members learn to value the contributions colleagues make and to set aside the irritations that arise from difference.

Performing: happens when the group demonstrates the qualities of collaborative working and mutual support that would be expected in teaming – high levels of coherence and psychological safety.

In order for the **Forming** stage to be really fruitful it must also include designing relationships, in order to foster curiosity and take assumptions out of the picture as much as possible. This will facilitate a sense of psychological safety and trust and lead right into Norming (hopefully skipping Storming).

In order to really be able to participate in the Design process we must know something about ourselves and our impact on others; enter the Superpowers. The Superpower quiz can be very useful to understand ourselves better, delineate roles, and help us re-design as necessary as new awareness arises. It also offers an opportunity to notice whether one or more superpowers might be missing from the group, right from the beginning.

⁸ <https://www.teambuilding.co.uk/theory/Forming-Storming-Norming-Performing.html>

Assembling teams with diverse superpowers can be helpful. Again, we as individuals don't have to figure out how to be good at everything, we can create groups or teams that move forward in a more constructive way by identifying our superpowers and designing relationships.

When creating teams, it is also critical to consider the impact the team wants to have, on each other, and on others outside the team, including colleagues and stakeholders. For example, if a team goal is to leave meetings feeling energized, or creative, or productive etc – what would that take? How can we create that by knowing and understanding our individual superpowers? Or if a goal is to motivate another team, how can that be curated? Remembering that we all have a bit of all the superpowers in us, which ones might we want to lean into more in different situations?

Think about what teams you are a part of both in your work and personal life. Which superpowers are represented on those teams? Who has a superpower that is hiding out? What might make your team really great? How can you dial up your superpower to help take your team to its highest potential?

Key Takeaways:

- Knowing and understanding your superpowers helps build strong teams
- Every team needs diversity in both skills and superpowers in order to maximize results
- Teams that understand their superpowers can be truly conscious and intentional when designing how they want to work together, resulting in improved cohesion, trust, and feelings of psychological safety



Chapter 11 - What is your kryptonite?

Just like Superman, or Superwoman, we all have things that get in the way of using our superpowers effectively. In coaching this might be referred to as saboteurs, gremlins, stories, etc. Stories that we've been told or have made up that influence our behavior in the present.

There are many possible origins to these stories. Sometimes our superpowers make others uncomfortable, and we may have been told at some point that when we show up that way it's not welcome, or it's "bad". Particularly if this happens when we're young or with someone in a position of authority we might internalize this story. In coaching lingo we might call these stories saboteurs, gremlins, or judges.

When coaching saboteurs we may want to keep in mind what superpower it may be trying to keep us from accessing and get curious about what the impact of that might be, or has been. There are certain aspects of every superpower that may be perceived negatively by others. Perhaps because they are made uncomfortable, or maybe they have been raised to believe certain behaviors or traits are bad or inappropriate.

An Initiator's kryptonite might be 'perfectionism', meaning that everything they produce has to be perfect. That kryptonite could turn an initiator to stone, making them unable to start for fear that will err along the way or the final product will be flawed in some way.

Every superpower has kryptonite, and unless we recognize it we may not be using all of our gifts and resources to their full potential. So, get curious.

Every superpower also has a shadow side, and sometimes the fear of activating that shadow side can turn into our kryptonite. If you find you are not using your superpower to its greatest impact, explore the possibility that you are trying too hard, or creating unintended impact that makes you afraid to try again. When we create an unintended impact that we don't know how to handle, that can be scary. Remember, kryptonite isn't fatal, it's just a blocker. There are ways to avoid it, and there are antidotes to help it recede when it shows up.

One strategy is to ask yourself, what assumptions am I making that are getting in the way of using my superpower? Write them down and then ask yourself, what else is possible? What else might be true? And what might a more positive or generous assumption⁹ be that might be more helpful?



Key Takeaways:

- We all have things that get in the way of using our superpowers effectively
- A common form of Kryptonite is a Saboteur or Gremlin telling us that our superpower is “bad”
- Remember, kryptonite isn’t fatal, it’s just a blocker

Conclusion

Just like curiosity, we are born with our superpowers. Being able to view your superpower positively can have a measurable impact on your life. Not everyone is going to like or love us, but for better or worse, whether we are liked or not, there is a way to be compelling, and that will help us to be seen and heard. When we show up and live as our most authentic selves we are empowered.

⁹ A generous assumption is simply another more positive perspective that is also possible that makes it easier to move forward

Appendix 1 - Self Assessment Sample

Completing the assessment: Select the answer that is most instinctive. Don't answer based on what you do a lot of, or what you happen to do very well. Choose the answer that reflects what YOU are naturally inclined to be/do, and what you believe others really notice and are compelled by. Choose only one response for each.

To complete the free online quiz and get your results by email follow [this link](#).

I think this person is:	More of a dreamer	
	More of a pragmatist	
If a team member is stuck, they are more likely to	Use humor as a distraction	
	Suggest something that has never been done	
Which of the following is truer about them	People sometimes find you intimidating	
	at social gatherings people are drawn to you	
		
When faced with sharing difficult news are they more likely to	Share something positive first	
	Just say it	

They are more inclined to	Lead a project	
	Support a project	
You would say that they are	compassionate	



	passionate	
What are you more drawn to in them	their insight	
	Their imagination	
Which statement is more resonant about this person	Building relationships is most important	
	Acknowledging the gifts in others is most important	
You would accurately describe them as	Risk taker	
	Reliable	
Would you say they are more	Direct	
	Directive	
As a team member they are more likely to	Bring everyone together	
	Point out alternative ways to do things	
Are you more compelled by them as	The class clown	
	The Cheerleader	
You are more compelled by their	Curiosity	
	Decisiveness	
Which statement is more resonant for you	they see possibility in everything	
	it seems easy for them to be honest with people	

		
Are they more likely to be described as	Resourceful	
	Witty	
You most appreciate their tendency to	Speak out against injustice	
	Notice when someone does something well	
You are more drawn to their	warmth	
	Sensitivity	
Would you say they are naturally more	forthcoming	
	daring	
You admire their	Imagination	
	Grit	
You most admire that they are	straightforward	
	Witty	
Which of the following is more true about them	you believe any problem can be solved	
	you believe every idea has value	
		

Appendix 2 - 360 Peer Assessment

This assessment is to help you understand your impact on others. You will ask friends/ colleagues/family to complete it with you as the subject of the questions.

While filling this out consider the person who is the subject of the questionnaire and what you find most compelling about them. For instance, they may be good at something, but that might not be what makes you drawn to them, or admire them. Please choose only one answer for each question, the one that is more resonant for you.

Again, don't answer based on what you see the person do a lot of, or even what they seem to do well. Choose the answer that reflects what YOU find most compelling about them. For example, consider the question of whether the person is more forthcoming or more daring. They may more often be daring, but what you find compelling is when they are forthcoming. In that case choose forthcoming. For example, I can often be counted on to tell the truth, but what might be more compelling for others is my tendency to take risks.

Our superpower is something that we do naturally, without effort, and which is often appreciated, admired, or respected by others. It may even make you uncomfortable, but you still find it compelling when they do show up that way.

Remember:

Choose only one answer for each question.

Choose the answer that is most resonant or that the person seems to do most naturally/comfortably

To access the 360 Peer Assessment and get your results and report follow this link:
[Peer Assessment](#)

		
I think this person is:	More of a dreamer	
	More of a pragmatist	
If a team member is stuck, they are more likely to	Use humor as a distraction	

	Suggest something that has never been done	
Which of the following is truer about them	People sometimes find you intimidating	
	at social gatherings people are drawn to you	
When faced with sharing difficult news are they more likely to	Share something positive first	
	Just say it	
They are more inclined to	Lead a project	
	Support a project	
You would say that they are	compassionate	
	passionate	
What are you more drawn to in them	their insight	
	Their imagination	
Which statement is more resonant about this person	Building relationships is most important	
	Acknowledging the gifts in others is most important	



You would accurately describe them as	Risk taker	
	Reliable	
Would you say they are more	Direct	
	Directive	
As a team member they are more likely to	Bring everyone together	
	Point out alternative ways to do things	
Are you more compelled by them as	The class clown	
	The Cheerleader	
You are more compelled by their	Curiosity	
	Decisiveness	
Which statement is more resonant for you	they see possibility in everything	
	it seems easy for them to be honest with people	
Are they more likely to be described as	Resourceful	
	Witty	
You most appreciate their tendency to	Speak out against injustice	
	Notice when someone does something well	
You are more drawn to their	warmth	
	Sensitivity	

		
Would you say they are naturally more	forthcoming	
	daring	
You admire their	Imagination	
	Grit	
You most admire that they are	straightforward	
	Witty	
Which of the following is truer about them	you believe any problem can be solved	
	you believe every idea has value	